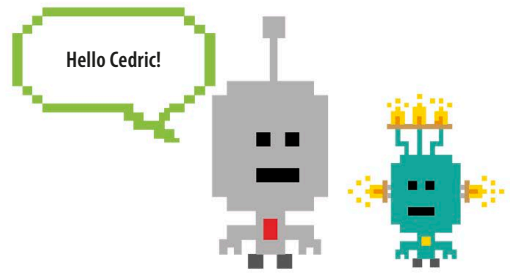


Your first program

Now that you've installed Python and IDLE, it's time to write your first program in Python. Follow these steps to create a simple program that greets the user with a cheery message.

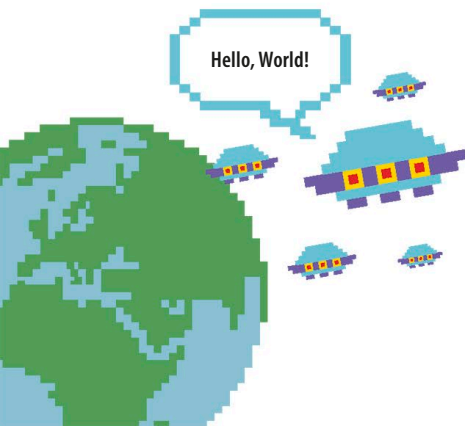
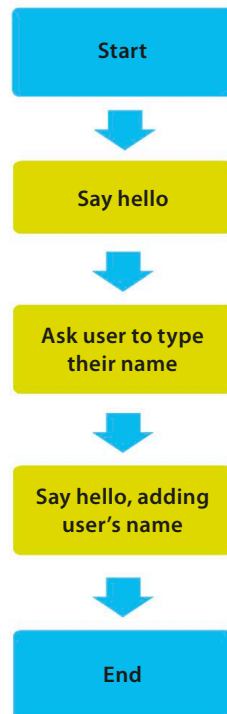


How it works

The program first displays the message "Hello, World!" and then asks your name. Once you've typed in your name, it says hello again, but this time it includes your name in the greeting. The program uses something called a variable to remember your name. A variable is used in coding to store information.

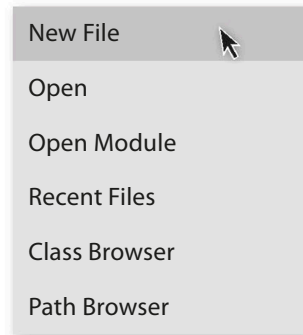
▷ Hello World flowchart

Programmers use diagrams called flowcharts to plan their programs and to show how they work. Each step is shown in a box, with an arrow leading to the next step. Sometimes the steps are questions and have more than one arrow leading onwards, depending on the answer to the question.

**1**

Launch IDLE

A shell window appears when you start IDLE. Ignore it and click on File in the IDLE menu. Choose New File to create an empty editor window where you can write your program.

**2**

Type the first line

In the editor window, type this line of text. The word "print" is a Python instruction that tells the computer to display something on the screen, such as the words "Hello, World!"

```
print('Hello, World!')
```

3

Save your file

Before you can run the code, you must save it. Go to the File menu and choose Save.

